

WAGONER COUNTY ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Meeting Minutes

Indian Capital Technology Center, Building B, Coweta Campus

31850 OK-51, Coweta, OK 74429

Wednesday, September 18, 2024

3:00 PM

Present: Norm Stephens, Chris Leffingwell, Brian Kuester, Tim Kelley

Absent: Orlin Emmons, Steve Nicholas, Tim Conroy

Motion to table the financial report by Chris Leffingwell and seconded by Brian Kuester. Motion carried.

Motion to table the minutes was made by Norm Stephens and seconded by Brian Kuester. Motion carried.

New Business

A. Economic Development Report

Darla Heller provided monthly economic development report which included the following:

- Responded to 1 project this month
- Project Bunny is moving forward. Site visit in September.
- Project Anthem is awaiting an announcement will not be this year. Predevelopment is moving forward
- Multi-Use Development in BA with commercial/ possible industrial
- Expansions
 - o Unarco/Newton Design/ SWIFT RECON working toward BIEP – equaling \$1.2M
 - o Zeeco expansion

B. Presentation, discussion, and possible action concerning providing renovation funding for the establishment of an economic development office and co-working space in Wagoner County at 216 S. Broadway, Coweta, (a Wagoner County owned property)

Darla Heller reported that a USDA \$150,000 grant was awarded to Wagoner County for the establishment of a co-working facility. Justification mission for the co-working space was presented and she reported the space can be utilized by Wagoner County, civic groups as well as small businesses. Budget figures were discussed.

Tim Kelley made the motion obligating WCEDA to fund the establishment of an economic development office and co-working space in Wagoner County at 216 S. Broadway, Coweta by utilizing a Wagoner County owned property not to exceed \$350,000.00. Norm Stephens seconded the motion. Motion carried.

C. Presentation, discussion, and possible action concerning funding a compilation or review for 2016-2017, 2017-2018, 2018-2019, 2019-2020, and an audit for 2020-2021, 2021-2022, 2022-2023 for the Town of Tullahassee.

Charity Marcus and Mayor Keisha Currin of Tallahassee provided a recap of past support of WCEDA agreed to pay for audits completed for up to \$9,000 for a four year audit two years ago. A \$4,500 check was cut two years ago and the accountant has not provided clarification that the check was received. Mayor is still trying to determine if the check was received by the accountant. The employee assigned to the project is no longer with the accounting firm. Tallahassee has provided about \$3,000.00 for the original audit. The Mayor reported that the audit is needed to apply for several grants that can be applied for if the audits are completed.

Through discussion the mayor was looking for direction. After discussion, Chairman Leffingwell, asked the mayor to account for the missing check by providing an email to Lori Hendricks. WCEDA detailed that \$4,500 remained appropriated and board further supports the direction the Town of Tallahassee determines to arrive at an audit that will allow the town to apply for needed grants. There was no action taken.

Old business

- a. Discussion and possible action regarding sale of 289th St. property. - Chris Leffingwell provided update that he and economic development staff have been in contact with the Muscogee Nation on infrastructure upgrades planed in the area. There continues to be interest in the property for housing development. No action taken.
- b. Presentation, discussion and possible action concerning the transfer of funding from WCEDA's account to a higher yielding interest accruing account with a Wagoner County bank. - Chris Leffingwell reported he is working with the Wagoner County Treasurer to get quotes from Wagoner County banks to obtain a 5.25% interest CD for a 6 month term. No action was required.

A motion was made by Norm Stephens to adjourn the meeting and seconded by Brian Kuester. Motion carried.

Submitted by:

Darla Heller, EDD

Orlin Emmons, Member

Tim Kelley, Member

Brian Kuester, Member

Chris Leffingwell, Chair

Steve Nicholas, Member

Norman Stephens, Member

Tim Conroy, Member